

“Cordless phones market is shifting towards DECT”



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Siemens Gigaset is one of the world's largest manufacturers of cordless phones and the market leader in Europe for DECT phones. The company is headquartered in Munich, Germany, and its product portfolio includes fixed-network phones, voice-over-IP (VoIP) devices, software solutions and home media products. Gigaset Communications is a licensee of the Siemens trademark.

Siemens Gigaset has recently launched a range of cordless phones in India. Hasan Palandöken, vice president-MEA and APAC, Siemens Gigaset, shares with Uma Bansal, deputy editor at EFY, his vision regarding the cordless phone market in India

What types of cordless phones are available? How does the frequency band affect their performance?

In India, both analogue and digital cordless phones are available. The Indian regulatory body has permitted use of 2.4 GHz and 5.8 GHz in the digital frequency spectrum for use of cordless phones in residential and enterprise environments.

Which frequency band is preferable to reduce interference with other wireless devices?

DECT is the most suitable for the same. We are also member of DECT Forum India, which is pitching to the Indian government for releasing the same.

What's DECT?

DECT is 'digital enhanced cordless telephony.' It is a European standard protocol now getting implemented globally.

What's the latest in technology and features?

Indian consumers desire features such as caller ID and speaker phone. Talking of the latest, we have model C580, which is made in Germany and has storage capacity for up to 150 numbers, which we are used to in the mobile environment.

Why is cordless VoIP a good idea?

VoIP cordless allows far more features than conventional cordless phones. IP phones bring multiline capabilities to your phone with up to six VoIP accounts. Support for high-definition sound performance provides exceptional sound quality for VoIP calls.

Also, with your phone connected to the Internet, it brings a new set of services and applications at your fingertips, such as weather forecast, e-mail viewer and online phonebook.

How secure are cordless phones?

Inbuilt digital scanning of the channel frequency ensures both efficient and secure mode of conversation.

Have mobile phones affected their sales?

Mobile phones are personalised devices and have actually become a commodity. Cordless phones, on the contrary, are household devices. It is convenient to use the same while answering the call from home with freedom from wires. Cordless phones allow you to have unrestricted movement in a home environment and one does not have to change the communication habit.

There is a huge market for cordless phones even today. For example, in India, cordless penetration is only 14 per cent compared to the 39-million landline market.

We believe both cellphone and cordless handsets will coexist and collaborate rather than compete.

How have these evolved over the years?

A decade ago, both the cordless and mobile phones had external antennae, while today none of them features it. These, in fact, work better with an internal antenna. Hence the innovation has benefited both.

What products have you recently launched in India?

Most of the models launched are made in Germany. Currently, we have models ranging in price from Rs 1999 to Rs 6400 in the Indian market.

What technology will drive the future of cordless phones?

The cordless phone market is shifting towards digital technology, which is mainly the DECT technology in which Siemens Gigaset is the market leader in Europe. ●